

Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles

ATP Men's Grand Slam Doubles, 2018–2025 · 1,793 matches after dropping 47 retirements / walkovers · Regression sample: 1,599 GS matches, 3,198 team-obs (complete ranking and nationality/language for all 4 players)

1. Data and Measures

Three culture measures capture teammate similarity. **Same nationality** and **same official language** are binary (0/1). **Language proximity** is a continuous 0–1 index of ethnolinguistic closeness (higher = more similar language family). All descriptive figures show the share of teams (pooled across winners and losers) that are *same* vs. *different* on each dimension.

Regressions use a team-level panel with tournament-by-year fixed effects, round fixed effects, and standard errors clustered by match. Controls: team average doubles ranking, opponent average ranking, teammate rank gap, top-100 singles indicator (either player). Culture measures enter one at a time. Matches are excluded if either team lacks a valid doubles ranking or if any player's nationality / language data is missing after all imputation (138 matches dropped: 14 for ranking, 124 for nationality / language). Where a player's registered country is unavailable, birthplace country is used as a fallback before coding any remaining unknowns as missing (NaN, not zero).

2. Observation Breakdown

The table below shows how the raw scraped data reduce to the regression sample used in Tables 3–5.

Step	Description	Matches	Change	Team-obs
1	Raw scraped dataset (2018–2025, excl. 2020)	1,840	—	3,680
2	Drop retirements / walkovers (20 walkovers · 9 retired in set 1 · 18 retired in set 2+)	1,793	–47	3,586
3	Drop matches: doubles ranking incomplete for ≥1 player	1,779	–14	3,558
4	Drop matches: nationality / language missing for ≥1 player (birthplace-country used as fallback before this step)	1,655	–124	3,310
5	Exclude Olympic matches (Tokyo 2021 · Paris 2024)	1,599	–56	3,198
→ Grand Slams regression sample (Tables 3–5)		1,599		3,198

Regression sub-samples: Table 4 (regular tiebreaks, sets 1–2) — 712 matches, 1,424 team-obs. Table 5 (adversity: all teams that lost set 1) — 1,599 obs, one per match.

3. Pressure Outcome Counts

Outcome	N	Share of matches
Set-1 tiebreak (7-pt)	445	24.8%
Set-2 tiebreak (7-pt)	470	26.2%
Any regular tiebreak (sets 1–2)	804	44.8%
Match tiebreak / super-tb (10-pt, set 3)	24	1.3%
Any tiebreak (all types)	896	50.0%
Match went to 3 sets	787	43.9%
Comeback wins (winner lost set 1)	351	19.6%

All matches (GS + Olympics, N=1,793). Match tiebreaks concentrated in Olympics (N=20) and Wimbledon post-2018 (N=4).

4. Olympic Cycle Descriptive Evidence

Table 2A — Tokyo 2021 cycle (Grand Slams only, Olympics excluded)

Period	GS window	N teams	Same Nat.	Diff Nat.	Same Lang.	Diff Lang.	Same Ling. Prox.	Diff Ling. Prox.
Pre-Tokyo	AO18 – USO19	1,006	40.1%	59.9%	55.1%	44.9%	55.9%	44.1%
Tokyo Prep	AO20 – Wim21 (ex Wim20)	364	42.0%	58.0%	56.1%	43.9%	56.1%	43.9%
Post-Tokyo	USO21 – USO22	604	39.2%	60.8%	54.8%	45.2%	55.5%	44.5%

N teams = GS matches × 2. Same/Diff = share of all teams (pooled winner + loser) on each cultural dimension.

Table 2B — Paris 2024 cycle (Grand Slams only, Olympics excluded)

Period	GS window	N teams	Same Nat.	Diff Nat.	Same Lang.	Diff Lang.	Same Ling. Prox.	Diff Ling. Prox.
Pre-Paris	AO22 – USO22	486	39.3%	60.7%	54.2%	45.8%	55.1%	44.9%
Paris Prep	AO23 – Wim24	860	42.5%	57.5%	59.1%	40.9%	59.6%	40.4%
Post-Paris	USO24 – USO25	626	45.3%	54.7%	57.7%	42.3%	59.1%	40.9%

N teams = GS matches × 2. Same/Diff = share of all teams (pooled winner + loser) on each cultural dimension.

Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles — Tokyo 2021 Cycle (Same vs. Diff, by Tournament-Year)

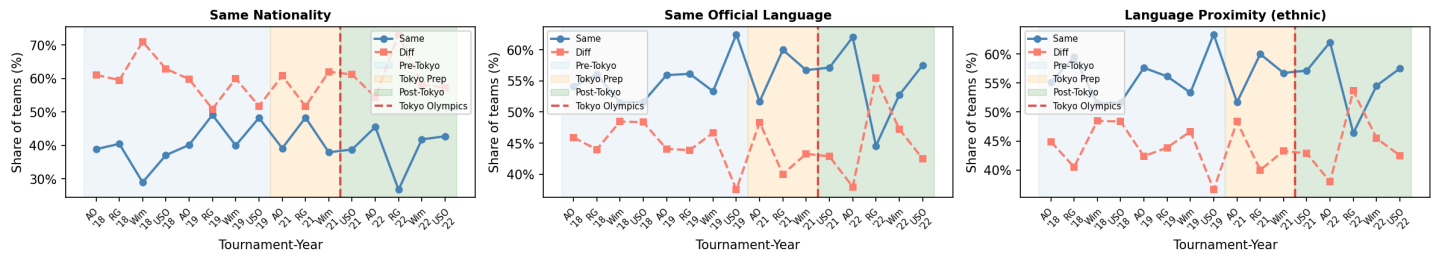


Figure 1. Share of teams that are same (solid) vs. different (dashed) on each cultural dimension, Grand Slams only. Shaded regions: Pre-Tokyo (blue), Tokyo Prep (orange), Post-Tokyo (green). Red dashed line marks the Tokyo Olympics (July–August 2021).

Cultural Homophily in Grand Slam Doubles — Paris 2024 Cycle (Same vs. Diff, by Tournament-Year)

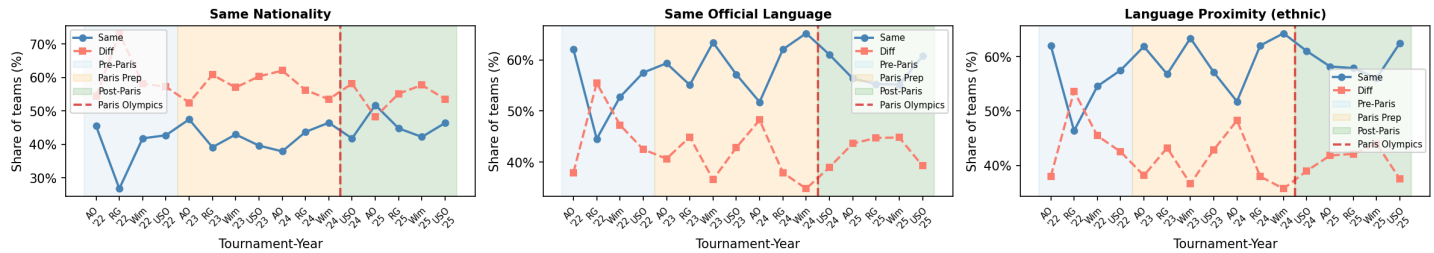


Figure 2. Share of teams that are same (solid) vs. different (dashed) on each cultural dimension, Grand Slams only. Shaded regions: Pre-Paris (blue), Paris Prep (orange), Post-Paris (green). Red dashed line marks the Paris Olympics (July–August 2024).

5. Regression Results

Logit coefficients (log-odds). Each column is a separate model. Standard errors in parentheses, clustered by match. Fixed effects: tournament $\times$ year and round (stage code). Sample: Grand Slams only, excluding matches with incomplete ranking or nationality / language data (N = 1,599 matches, 3,198 team-obs; see Section 2).

Table 3 — Outcome: Match Win | N = 3,198 team-obs (1,599 matches)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	+0.0577 (0.0791) p=0.466	+0.1163 (0.0765) p=0.129	+0.0968 (0.0765) p=0.205
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0041 ^{***} (0.0006)	−0.0041 ^{***} (0.0006)	−0.0041 ^{***} (0.0006)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)	+0.0033 ^{***} (0.0003)
Teammate rank gap	+0.0008 (0.0005)	+0.0008 (0.0005)	+0.0008 (0.0005)
Top-100 singles player	+0.0825 (0.1515)	+0.0823 (0.1518)	+0.0840 (0.1517)
Pseudo-R ²	0.092	0.093	0.093

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. Standard errors clustered by match. FE: tournament × year, round. No culture measure is statistically significant at conventional levels.

Table 4 — Outcome: Tiebreak Win (7-pt regular tiebreaks, sets 1–2) | N = 1,424 team-obs (712 matches)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	+0.1044 (0.1199) p=0.384	+0.0593 (0.1162) p=0.610	+0.0411 (0.1160) p=0.723
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0007 (0.0006)	−0.0007 (0.0006)	−0.0007 (0.0006)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0012 ^{***} (0.0004)	+0.0012 ^{***} (0.0004)	+0.0012 ^{***} (0.0004)
Teammate rank gap	−0.0008 (0.0006)	−0.0008 (0.0006)	−0.0008 (0.0006)
Top-100 singles player	−0.4210 [*] (0.2311)	−0.4110 [*] (0.2307)	−0.4094 [*] (0.2305)
Pseudo-R ²	0.022	0.022	0.021

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. Standard errors clustered by match. FE: tournament × year, round. Sample restricted to matches with a 7-pt regular tiebreak in sets 1 or 2 (excludes 10-pt super-tiebreaks in Olympics and Wimbledon). Of the 1,599 baseline matches, 712 (44.5%) had a regular tiebreak; each contributes two team-observations → 712 × 2 = 1,424 obs. Including all tiebreak types (N = 1,594 obs, 797 matches) gives near-identical culture coefficients (+0.024, +0.023, +0.001; all p > 0.80).

Table 5 — Outcome: Comeback Win (Adversity Sample) | N = 1,599 obs (1,599 matches, 1 obs per match)

Variable	(1) Same Nationality	(2) Same Language	(3) Lang. Proximity
Culture measure	−0.2371 [*] (0.1365) p=0.083	−0.3257 ^{**} (0.1324) p=0.014	−0.3316 ^{**} (0.1327) p=0.012
Team avg. doubles rank	−0.0027 ^{***} (0.0010)	−0.0028 ^{***} (0.0010)	−0.0028 ^{***} (0.0010)
Opponent avg. doubles rank	+0.0020 ^{***} (0.0004)	+0.0021 ^{***} (0.0004)	+0.0021 ^{***} (0.0004)
Teammate rank gap	+0.0001 (0.0008)	+0.0001 (0.0008)	+0.0001 (0.0008)
Top-100 singles player	−0.2028 (0.2626)	−0.2025 (0.2628)	−0.2062 (0.2627)
Pseudo-R ²	0.065	0.067	0.067

*** p<0.01 ** p<0.05 * p<0.10. HC3 heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors (one observation per match, no within-match clustering). FE: tournament × year, round. Every match has exactly one team that lost set 1, so the adversity sample spans all 1,599 baseline matches (N = 1,599 obs = 1 per match). Outcome breakdown: comeback win (0|1|1, N=310, 19.4%), 3-set loss (0|1|0, N=392, 24.5%), straight-set loss (0|0, N=897, 56.1%). Tournament × year cells with no outcome variation dropped.